

A surname counts for reaching the top of the state and for nothing below it

Left: how much more often two people sharing a surname end their careers in the same band of the hierarchy than when that outcome is shuffled among people of the same entry decade and career span. The bands do not overlap. Only the top one departs from chance — 1.34× for the 877 people who finish at *gouverneur* or above. The other 4 bands, covering 97% of the administrative line, run between 0.98× and 1.05×, and none of them is separable from chance in either direction: namesakes share an arrival at the top, not a ceiling further down. Right: the top band split by how many people carry the surname, running from 2.34× for a name held by 3–5 people to 1.19× for one held by more than sixty — the direction kinship predicts, since a rare name shared is evidence of a family and a common one shared is mostly not.

